

Elissa Esterlein

Data Analyst & Developer | AI Automation, LLM APIs & RAG

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data analyst and self-taught developer who builds AI tools that people use in their daily work. I've shipped a multimodal photo classifier built on the Claude Vision API that office staff use every day, a local RAG chatbot over policy documents, a multi-model evaluation comparing OpenAI, Anthropic, and Gemini output, and data pipelines that rebuild and republish themselves when new data arrives. I have 7+ years of experience turning messy data into reliable, decision-ready information, and I like finding the manual step in a process and automating it away.

CORE SKILLS

AI & LLMs	Anthropic Claude API, OpenAI API, Gemini, vision/multimodal classification, prompt engineering, RAG, embeddings & vector indexing, LlamaIndex, Ollama (local open-source models)
Automation & Pipelines	GitHub Actions CI/CD, scheduled API ingestion, ETL, CSV/Excel import automation, data validation & QA
Programming & APIs	Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Node.js/Express, REST APIs, JSON, HTTP, JWT auth
Data & Databases	SQL (SQL Server, PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Access), Pandas, GeoPandas, Prisma, Excel (advanced), Tableau, Power BI
Infrastructure	Docker, nginx, AWS (EC2, RDS, S3), Heroku, GitHub Pages, Git/GitHub

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gunnison County Assessor's Office — <i>Data Analyst</i>	Gunnison, CO Jul 2025 – Present
- Built an AI photo-processing app that office appraisers use every day. It uses Claude Vision and GPS metadata to classify, match, and rename field photos for about \$0.002 per photo, replacing a manual sorting step. - Automated data publishing with a GitHub Actions pipeline. Uploading a new export cleans the data and republishes a 17,500-parcel review dashboard in about two minutes. - Write SQL in SQL Server and Access to extract, transform, and deliver property data for appraisal staff and the public. - Support state-mandated deliverables (tax rolls, abstracts of assessment, and certifications of value to ~42 taxing entities) through data validation and QA workflows with fixed regulatory deadlines. - Built public-facing dashboards and mapping tools that let staff and residents explore parcel, building, and land data without GIS software.	
MedAware Systems — <i>Data Analyst</i>	Boulder, CO (Remote) Jan 2015 – Jan 2021
- Analyzed medical literature and research data to inform clinical research tools used by client organizations. - Designed search strategies and inclusion criteria that improved the precision and efficiency of database research. - Maintained and validated key business datasets; monitored metrics, flagged changes, and recommended process improvements. - Partnered with clients to define research needs and presented findings to internal teams. Worked fully remote for six years.	

AI & AUTOMATION PROJECTS

Live demos, code, and more projects at eesterlein.github.io

Appraiser Photo Processor — *multimodal AI in production*

[GitHub](#)

- Desktop app that reads each photo's GPS and compass data, matches it to the nearest parcel, classifies the shot with Claude Vision, and renames and date-stamps it to office standards.
- Designed the prompts and classification categories; runs at about \$0.002 per photo; packaged with PyInstaller and deployed to staff Windows machines.

Python · Claude Vision API · Prompt engineering · EXIF/GPS · PyInstaller

Private RAG Chatbot & Local Coding Assistant

[GitHub](#)

- Built a retrieval-augmented generation chatbot that answers questions from internal policy documents. Loaded documents, generated embeddings, and built a vector index for conversational retrieval.
- Runs fully on-device with Ollama and open-source models (Mistral, DeepSeek-Coder), so sensitive documents never leave the machine.

Python · LlamaIndex · Ollama · RAG · Embeddings · Vector indexing

Multi-Model Website Audit — *OpenAI vs. Anthropic vs. Gemini*

[Live](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Ran the same research prompt and scoring rubric through ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude across 24 Colorado counties, then merged the three reviews into one ranked action plan. One model caught a state deadline change the other two missed.

Prompt engineering · OpenAI · Anthropic Claude · Google Gemini · LLM evaluation

Land Attributes Dashboard — *automated data pipeline*

[Live](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Parcel review tool covering ~17,500 parcels that flags missing attributes and data-entry errors. A GitHub Actions workflow cleans each new data upload and republishes the site automatically.

Python · Pandas · GeoPandas · GitHub Actions · MapLibre GL JS · JavaScript

Gunnison Airport Tracker — *scheduled API automation*

[GitHub](#)

- Automated flight tracker that pulls OpenSky REST API data every hour, logs repeat aircraft to PostgreSQL, and runs unattended on Heroku.

Node.js · REST APIs · JSON · PostgreSQL · Heroku

Gunnison Permit Portal

[GitHub](#)

- Built and deployed a permit search and staff portal for four jurisdictions. Staff upload CSV/Excel exports, and the app learns and remembers each jurisdiction's column layout. Includes JWT auth and document attachments.

React · Node.js/Express · PostgreSQL/Prisma · JWT · AWS EC2, RDS, S3

Assessor Map Platform

[Live](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Full-stack GIS platform where non-technical users upload Excel/CSV data, join it to parcel geometries, and build interactive maps. Includes wildfire detections refreshed every 30 minutes. Deployed with Docker, nginx, and PostGIS.

React · TypeScript · Node.js · PostgreSQL/PostGIS · OGC APIs · Docker

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Western State Colorado University — *Bachelor of Arts, Biology*

Gunnison, CO

- Google AI Essentials Certificate · Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate
- Colorado Assessor Licensure Track (RAEP): Basic Appraisal Principles & Procedures, Ad Valorem Mass Appraisal, USPAP